THE CHALLENGE · A FILE STORAGE APP

The server filed things away. We opened the other drawers.

REQUEST RECORDED IN THE JOURNAL	`GET /raw?filename=../../challenge.db`	
EXPECTED DIRECTORY	`/app/uploads/<compte>/`	Files belonging to our account.
CONSTRUCTED PATH	`/app/~~uploads/<compte>/~~../../challenge.db`	Each `../` goes up one directory.
ACTUAL TARGET FILE	`/app/challenge.db`	The account database, outside our directory.

`/download/…` blocks this escape `/raw?filename=…` allows it

Teaching reconstruction. No HTTP capture was preserved.

THE TAKEAWAY

Joining a path **does not guarantee it stays inside the allowed directory.**

THE BREAKTHROUGH · DO NOT STOP AT THE FIRST PLAUSIBLE STRING

A fake flag in the database.
A real lead right beside it.

THE TRAP A password looked like a flag. DECOY

01

Read the accounts

The database also contains an administrator account.

→

02

Log in

The admin dashboard shows more files.

→

03

Follow the clue

`flag.txt` says the flag is hidden in `flag.maze`.

THE TAKEAWAY

The right path leads to a maze made of characters.

THE SOLVER · BREADTH-FIRST SEARCH, OR BFS

Explore the neighbours. Keep track of the way back.

SAVED SOLVER LOGIC · PSEUDOCODE

```
queue ← [entrance]
while the queue contains a cell:
  take the next cell
  add its unvisited open neighbours
  remember their previous cell
```

= wall · **>** = gate · letters lie in the corridors

01 **Explore in layers**

First the neighbours, then their neighbours.

02 **Find the exit**

Each cell remembers where it came from.

03 **Follow the predecessors back**

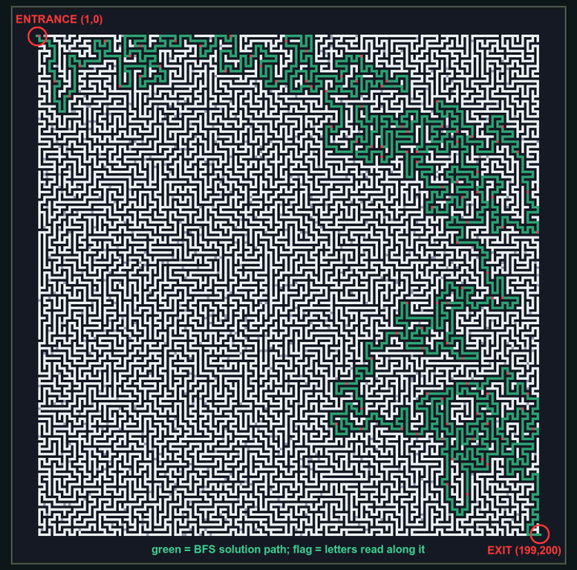
Keep only the entrance → exit path.

THE TAKEAWAY

Read **the letters along this path**, not every letter in the maze.

THE SOLVE · FOLLOW THE MAZE

The path to the exit spells out the flag.



SAVED EVIDENCE · CLICK TO ENLARGE

201 × 201 cells in the maze

1. Start at the entrance.
2. Explore accessible passages.
3. Read the letters on the path to the exit.

2 783 POSITIONS ON THE PATH

`BA26{tHis_Is_a_rEally_loNG_flag_…}`

THE TAKEAWAY

File access opens the door. **The maze path gives the answer.**